

The Best Advice I Ever Got

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Otis India is the Indian arm of the global elevator and escalator manufacturer and services brand



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‘The strength of any business is people power’

What was the problem you were grappling with?

Otis India installed the first elevator in the country in 1892, but by the late 1990s, it was losing its edge. At the same time competition had gained considerable momentum. We even made losses in 2011. All arenas of operations were under stress and employees were demoralised.

Who did you approach for advice?

I had discussions with my leadership team who gave me the various dimensions we needed to solve the problem together. I continued to lean on a distillate of previous and current advice from my family, bosses as well as ancient scriptures and learnings from spiritual and management gurus. I also turned to lessons from my previous assignments.

What was the advice you received?

The strength of any business is people power. Employees have emotions and while leaders must have empathy, we also need to weave in objectivity in decision-making without giving in to emotions. I also gleaned that one will not always have the best person for every job, and it is the craft of the leader to help employees push the limits and enable them reach their fullest potential.

How effective was it in resolving the problem?

We looked deep inside, wide outside and came up with our vision: UDAAN—a flight into a brighter future—setting the path for an engaged, dynamic and customer-focussed culture within the organisation. We began working from the ground up; strategies were re-visited, business models were revised, and new products were introduced. We regained lost ground, improved employee satisfaction, share of segment and overall financial performance and began winning prestigious orders. **BT**

—VIDYA S.

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